



Your AI prototype isn't a product. It's a specification.

And I mean that as a compliment.

02

Easy to build, hard to own

I built my own meeting note-taker to replace a cheap subscription. It saved money at first, and then the maintenance cost me more.

For one person, pointless.



03

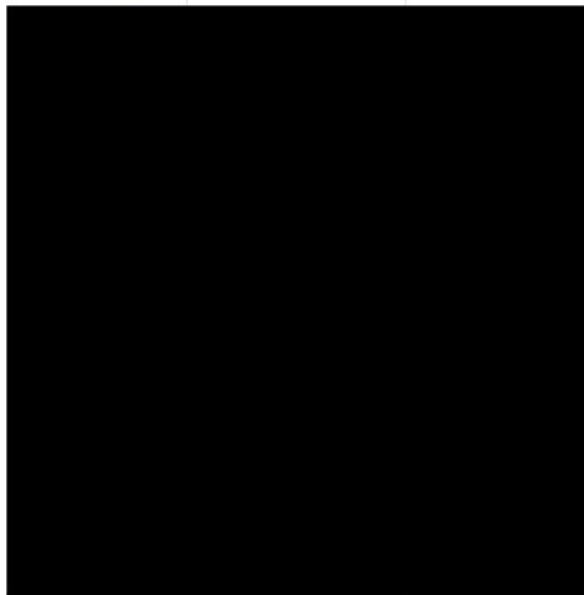
Treat the prototype as the brief

For a firm of twenty or thirty people, my rule of thumb is that around 90% of what you need already exists in platforms you can buy.



Configure the 90%, build only the 10%

Configure ~90%



Build ~10%



existing platforms

truly yours

ILLUSTRATIVE · SHARE OF NEEDS, RULE OF THUMB

For a firm of twenty or thirty people, most of what you need already exists. Your effort goes to the rest.

05

Build only the part nobody sells

Build the 10% that is truly yours and make it talk to the tool you already pay for, so someone else fixes the bugs and upkeep stays low.

I prefer to pay for a system when it's good.



**Use the prototype
as the brief,
configure what
already exists, and
build only the part
that is truly yours.**

**Weighing build or buy in your office? I'm glad
to think it through with you.**

